THEME 1.2
MIGRATION

Causes of Migration · Push & Pull Factors · Lee's Model
Impacts on Source & Destination · Managing Migration

CENTRAL AMERICA | MEXICO | USA | BORDER POLICY

BY THE END OF THIS PACK YOU WILL BE ABLE TO:

- Define migration and distinguish between different types
- Explain push and pull factors using Lee's Model of Migration
- Describe the causes and routes of migration from Central America and Mexico to the USA
- Explain the impacts of this migration on source countries (Mexico & Central America)
- Explain the impacts on the destination country (USA)
- Evaluate strategies used to manage migration at the US-Mexico border
- Answer all question types including the 7-mark extended response

SYLLABUS CHECKLIST — THEME 1.2 MIGRATION

1.2a Define the term migration and distinguish between internal, international, voluntary and forced migration	3
1.2b Explain push and pull factors that cause people to migrate	3–4
1.2c Describe Lee's Model of Migration and the role of intervening obstacles	4
1.2d Describe migration routes and patterns (case study: Central America & Mexico to USA)	5–6
1.2e Explain the causes of migration from Central America and Mexico to the USA	6–7
1.2f Evaluate the impacts of migration on source countries (Mexico & Central America)	8
1.2g Evaluate the impacts of migration on the destination country (USA)	9
1.2h Describe and evaluate strategies to manage migration	10–11

EXAM ALERT: Migration appears on **Paper 1, Section A** (compulsory). Questions follow the 1+2+3+4+7 mark structure. The 7-mark question requires a **named case study with specific data**. You must be able to: (a) explain causes of migration with named push AND pull factors; (b) evaluate impacts on BOTH source AND destination countries; (c) assess management strategies with a balanced conclusion. Examiners reward specific place names, statistics and the ability to evaluate rather than just describe.

KEY VOCABULARY

Migration	The movement of people from one place to another, either temporarily or permanently.
Internal migration	Movement within a country's borders — e.g. rural to urban migration.
International migration	Movement across national borders from one country to another.
Voluntary migration	Movement by choice, usually in search of better economic opportunities or quality of life.
Forced migration	Movement where people have no real choice — driven by war, persecution, famine or disaster.
Economic migrant	Someone who moves primarily to improve their financial situation and find work.
Refugee	A person who flees their country due to a well-founded fear of persecution (race, religion, nationality or political opinion). Protected under the 1951 UN Refugee Convention.
Asylum seeker	A person who has applied for refugee status and is awaiting a decision.
Push factor	A negative condition in the origin country that drives people to leave — e.g. poverty, violence, unemployment.
Pull factor	A positive condition in the destination country that attracts migrants — e.g. higher wages, safety, family connections.
Intervening obstacle	A barrier making migration more difficult — e.g. cost of travel, border controls, language barriers, distance.
Remittances	Money sent home by migrants to support families in their country of origin. Globally over $700 billion/year — exceeding foreign aid.
Brain drain	The loss of skilled, educated workers from a developing country as they emigrate for better opportunities.
Chain migration	When migrants follow routes already used by earlier migrants from their community, using established networks for support.
Undocumented migrant	A person living in a country without legal permission or valid immigration status.

PART A: TYPES OF MIGRATION

Classification of Migration

Internal Within a country's borders Example: Mexican rural workers moving to Mexico City	**Voluntary** Choice-based, usually economic Example: Mexican worker moving to Texas for work	**Regular / documented** Legal status, visa, work permit Example: H-2A agricultural visa workers
International Across national borders Example: Honduran family moving to the USA	**Forced** No real choice — conflict, persecution Example: Salvadoran family fleeing gang threats	**Irregular / undocumented** No legal permission ~11 million undocumented people in USA

PART B: PUSH & PULL FACTORS

Migration is driven by a combination of **push factors** (negatives forcing people to leave) and **pull factors** (positives attracting people to a destination). In the Central America and Mexico to USA migration, both sets of factors are exceptionally strong.

PUSH FACTORS — SOURCE COUNTRIES (Central America & Mexico)	PULL FACTORS — DESTINATION (United States of America)
Economic poverty: GDP per capita in Honduras $2,900; El Salvador $4,500 vs USA $80,000. Extreme inequality — top 10% own 40% of wealth.	**Economic opportunity:** US minimum wage $7.25/hour = ~$15,000/year — 5-10x earnings in Central America. Strong demand for low-skilled labour.
Gang violence & insecurity: Honduras homicide rate 36/100,000 (2023) — one of world's highest. MS-13 and Barrio 18 gangs extort businesses and recruit by force.	**Safety and rule of law:** US homicide rate 6.3/100,000 — far lower. Functioning police, courts, and legal protection largely absent in source regions.
Unemployment: Youth unemployment 20-30% across Central America. Few formal jobs; informal economy exploitative and insecure.	**Family networks:** ~37 million people of Mexican origin in USA. Established communities provide housing, jobs, and social support for new arrivals (chain migration).
Climate shocks: Hurricanes Eta and Iota (2020) destroyed crops and infrastructure across Honduras and Guatemala, destroying livelihoods for hundreds of thousands.	**Education & healthcare:** US school system and healthcare (however imperfect) far superior to source country provision — important for families with children.
Political instability: Weak governments, corruption, and lack of social services. Nicaragua under authoritarian rule; Honduras plagued by political violence.	**Historical migration patterns:** Long tradition of migration creates known routes, established coyote networks, and community knowledge reducing perceived risk of the journey.

Lee's Model of Migration (1966)

Geographer Everett Lee proposed that migration decisions are shaped by four factors:

1. Origin factors	Conditions at home — a mix of positive and negative factors (push)	Gang violence, poverty, unemployment, climate disasters (push people out)
2. Destination factors	Conditions at destination — a mix of positive and negative factors (pull)	Higher wages, safety, established communities (pull people in)
3. Intervening obstacles	Barriers making migration difficult to complete	3,145 km border; US Border Patrol; cost of coyote ($3,000-10,000); desert crossing; cartels
4. Personal characteristics	Individual factors affecting the decision to migrate	Age (mostly 18-35 male); education level; risk tolerance; family responsibilities; desperation

PART C: MIGRATION ROUTES — CENTRAL AMERICA & MEXICO TO USA

Fig. 1: Main migration routes from Central America and Mexico to the USA Fig. 2: Migrants awaiting processing at the US-Mexico border, Arizona 2023

The Main Route — Over 3,000 km of Danger

Most migrants from Central America and Mexico follow the **Pan-American corridor northward** through Mexico to reach the US border. The journey is extremely dangerous and expensive:

1. Departure (Guatemala/Honduras/El Salvador)	Cross Guatemala by bus or foot. Many from Honduras and El Salvador first cross into Guatemala — relatively open borders at this stage.	Robbery, extortion by local gangs; deportation by Guatemalan authorities
2. Mexico — Southern Border	Cross the Suchiate River into Mexico (Chiapas). The 'Bestia' freight train network used by many migrants north through southern Mexico toward Mexico City and beyond.	Train accidents (losing limbs or life); kidnapping by Mexican cartels; extortion at checkpoints; sexual assault; abandonment in desert
3. Mexico — Transit North	Shelter in migrant houses (casas del migrante). Most routes converge at Ciudad Juarez, Tijuana, Nogales or Matamoros — border crossing cities.	Cartels now control most crossing points and charge 'fees' of $1,000-3,000; migrants kidnapped for ransom; Mexican police corruption
4. US Border Crossing	Cross into USA — officially at ports of entry (to claim asylum) or illegally between ports. Desert crossings (Sonoran Desert) or Rio Grande river crossings. Average crossing: 3-5 days walking in extreme conditions.	Dehydration and heat death (600+ deaths/year in Sonoran Desert); drowning in Rio Grande; US Border Patrol apprehension; hypothermia in winter crossings
5. Destination Cities	California (Los Angeles), Texas (Houston, Dallas), New York, Florida, Illinois (Chicago). Established Mexican and Central American communities provide initial support.	Risk of deportation; exploitation by employers; difficulty accessing services without documentation

Key Migration Statistics (2023):

- **US Customs & Border Protection (CBP) encounters:** 2.47 million at southern border in FY2023 — a record high
- **Top source countries:** Mexico (largest single source), Venezuela, Cuba, Honduras, Guatemala, El Salvador ('Northern Triangle')
- **Undocumented population in USA:** ~11 million people (Pew Research Center, 2022)
- **Cost of hiring a coyote (people smuggler):** $3,000–$10,000+ per person
- **Deaths crossing the Sonoran Desert:** 600+ per year; over 10,000 recorded since 1994
- **Journey duration:** typically 1–3 months from Central America; crossing Mexico alone takes weeks
- **Mexico's role:** both a source country (largest single source) AND a transit country for Central Americans

CASE STUDY: WHY PEOPLE LEAVE — CAUSES IN DEPTH

Honduras: The Violence Push Factor

Honduras consistently ranks among the world's most dangerous countries outside active war zones. Two transnational gangs — **MS-13 (Mara Salvatrucha)** and **Barrio 18** — originating in Los Angeles and deported to Central America in the 1990s, now control large territories.

Gang activities driving emigration include:

- **Extortion:** businesses and households pay 'war tax' — failure to pay results in murder
- **Forced recruitment:** teenagers forcibly recruited; refusal means death threats for entire family
- **Territorial control:** entire neighbourhoods are gang territory — living there means compliance
- **Femicide:** Honduras has among the world's highest rates of violence against women

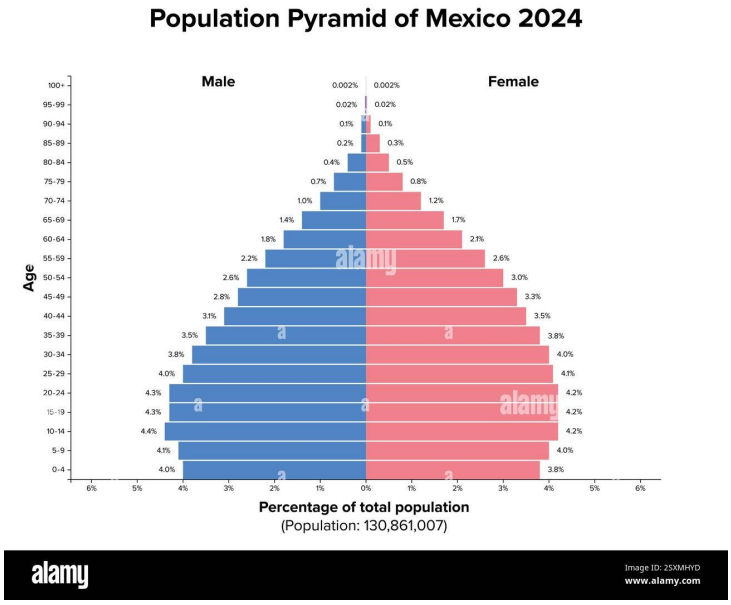
Fig. 3: Honduran security forces at a detention facility — state violence and gang violence both push people to flee.

Mexico: Both Source and Transit Country

Mexico is unique in this migration system — it is simultaneously the **largest single source country** of migrants to the USA and the **main transit country** for Central Americans heading north.

MEXICO AS SOURCE COUNTRY	MEXICO AS TRANSIT COUNTRY
Scale: ~11.7 million Mexican-born people live in the USA — the largest diaspora from any single country. A further 25 million US citizens are of Mexican descent.	**Route:** Central Americans must travel the entire length of Mexico (~3,000 km) to reach the US border. Journey takes weeks to months.
Push factors: Drug cartel violence (60,000+ deaths/year); economic inequality (Gini coefficient 0.45); unemployment in rural southern states (Oaxaca, Chiapas, Guerrero).	**Cartel control:** Mexican cartels (Sinaloa, CJNG) now control most border crossing points and charge migrants 'fees' — or kidnap them for ransom.
Pull factors: Cultural connections (Spanish language, family networks); wages 5-10x higher; 3,145 km shared border makes it the world's most-crossed international border.	**Mexican state:** Mexico detains and deports Central Americans under US pressure — but corruption means many officials take bribes to allow passage.
Trend: Net migration from Mexico to USA has declined since 2010 — more Mexicans now return home than arrive. Central Americans and others now dominate border crossings.	**Asylum:** Mexico itself is a signatory to the UN Refugee Convention and grants some asylum, but capacity is limited and backlogs severe.

Mexico's Population Pyramid 2024 — Evidence of Migration Impact



Mexico's population pyramid (Fig. 4) shows a **notably smaller bar** for men aged 25-40 compared to women. This **gender imbalance** at working age is a demographic 'scar' caused by male emigration.

Key observations:

- **25-35 male cohort** visibly smaller than female equivalent
- Reflects decades of **working-age male emigration** to the USA
- Overall pyramid is **transitional** (Stage 3 DTM) — declining birth rate, growing middle-age cohort
- Large 10-25 age group = significant **future migration pressure**

Mexico's fertility rate has fallen from 6.7 (1970) to 1.9 (2024) — evidence of economic and social development, but still generating a large working-age population seeking opportunity.

Fig. 4: Population pyramid of Mexico 2024 (total population: 130.9 million). Note the smaller male bars in the 25-40 working-age group.

PART D: IMPACTS ON SOURCE COUNTRIES — MEXICO & CENTRAL AMERICA

Migration has profound effects on the countries people leave. These effects are **both positive and negative** — a balanced evaluation is essential for exam success.

POSITIVE IMPACTS ON SOURCE COUNTRIES	NEGATIVE IMPACTS ON SOURCE COUNTRIES
Remittances — the biggest positive: Mexico receives ~$63 billion/year in remittances (2023) — its largest source of foreign currency, exceeding oil exports. El Salvador: 24% of GDP. Honduras: 27% of GDP. This money funds food, education, housing and local businesses.	**Brain drain:** The most educated, skilled and ambitious individuals tend to emigrate first (positive self-selection). Mexico loses doctors, engineers and teachers. This depletes human capital needed for development and economic growth.
Reduced unemployment pressure: Emigration reduces competition for scarce jobs at home, easing social pressure. Particularly significant in rural areas of Honduras, Guatemala and Mexico's southern states.	**Gender imbalance and family breakdown:** Male emigration creates communities where women, children and elderly are left behind. Children grow up without fathers; relationships break down; social fabric weakens. Higher rates of teenage pregnancy in female-dominated communities.
Skills and knowledge transfer: Returning migrants bring back savings, skills, languages and business ideas. Many set up small businesses in Mexico and Central America after working in the USA, stimulating local economies.	**Dependency on remittances:** Communities and governments become dependent on remittance income — when US economic conditions worsen (e.g. 2008 recession), remittances fall sharply and communities suffer acutely.
Population pressure relief: For densely populated countries with high fertility rates, emigration reduces pressure on land, water, food and social services — particularly in rural areas.	**Population decline in rural areas:** Entire villages in Oaxaca (Mexico) and Guatemala are effectively depopulated — mostly elderly people remaining. Schools close; local economies stagnate; agricultural land is abandoned.

FOCUS: Remittances as Development Finance

Remittances from the USA to Latin America and the Caribbean totalled **$145 billion in 2022** (World Bank). For Mexico, this exceeded $63 billion — more than tourism, foreign direct investment, or oil exports. In El Salvador, remittances represent 24% of GDP; in Honduras, 27% of GDP. Unlike foreign aid, remittances go directly to families and are spent on food, healthcare, education and housing — with immediate development impact. However, this creates dangerous **remittance dependency**: any disruption (US recession, stricter immigration enforcement) immediately impacts millions of households.

PART E: IMPACTS ON THE DESTINATION COUNTRY — USA

The USA receives more international migrants than any other country — over 47 million foreign-born residents (14% of total population). Latino migrants from Mexico and Central America are the largest group, concentrated in California, Texas, New York, Florida and Illinois.

Fig. 5: New York City — a major destination for migrants from Latin America. New York's Latino population exceeds 2.4 million.

POSITIVE IMPACTS ON USA	NEGATIVE IMPACTS ON USA
Labour force contribution: Immigrants fill critical labour shortages in agriculture, construction, food processing, domestic care and hospitality — sectors US-born workers increasingly avoid. California's agricultural sector would collapse without migrant workers.	**Fiscal and service pressure:** Undocumented migrants typically cannot access most federal benefits but use emergency healthcare, schools (for their US-born children) and local services. Estimated net fiscal cost $68 billion/year (Heritage Foundation) — though other estimates show positive net contribution.
Economic contribution: Immigrants (documented and undocumented) contribute ~$2 trillion annually to US GDP. They pay sales taxes and many pay income and payroll taxes using Individual Taxpayer Identification Numbers (ITINs), contributing to Social Security they often cannot claim.	**Political tensions:** Immigration is the USA's most politically divisive issue. Border security, deportation policy, and amnesty for undocumented migrants dominate elections. The issue polarises communities and makes rational policy-making extremely difficult.
Cultural diversity and innovation: Latino culture has enriched US music, food, language and arts. Immigrant entrepreneurs start businesses at higher rates than native-born Americans. Many tech companies founded by immigrants or children of immigrants.	**Wage depression in low-skill sectors:** Some economists argue large numbers of low-skill migrants depress wages for the poorest US-born workers (often African Americans and earlier Latino immigrants) competing for the same jobs.
Demographic support: Immigrants are typically of working age with higher fertility rates than native-born Americans. This helps support the ageing US population, fund Social Security, and maintain workforce size.	**Security concerns:** While evidence shows immigrants commit crimes at lower rates than native-born Americans, illegal border crossings facilitate drug smuggling (particularly fentanyl). US drug overdose deaths exceeded 107,000 in 2023.

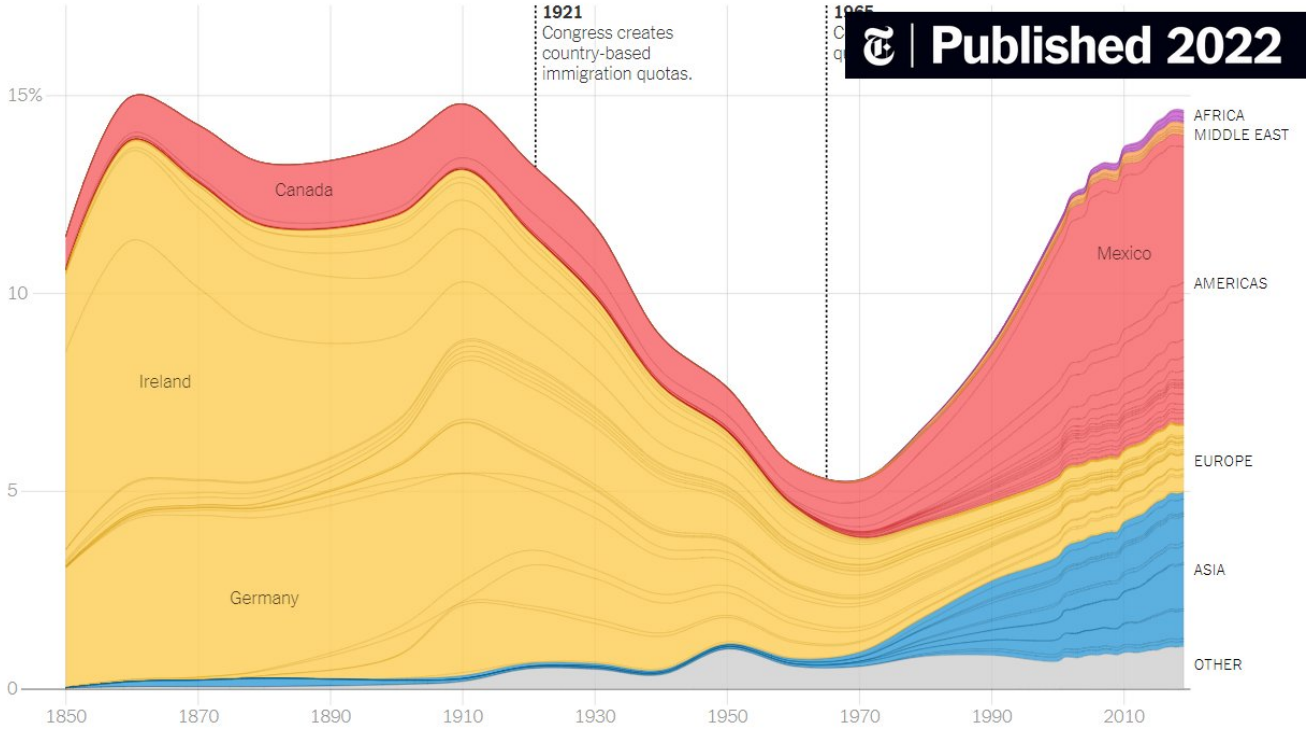


Fig. 6: Share of US population that is foreign-born, 1850–2022, by region of origin (New York Times, 2022). Note the dramatic rise of Latin American migration (red/pink) from the 1970s, with Mexico as the dominant source country.

PART F: MANAGING MIGRATION — US POLICY RESPONSES

Fig. 7: The US-Mexico border fence in Arizona — aerial view. The barrier covers approximately 700 miles (1,120 km) of the 1,954-mile (3,145 km) border. Debate over extending the wall has dominated US politics for over a decade.

The USA uses a combination of **border security (enforcement)**, **legal pathways**, and **international cooperation** to manage migration. Each approach has strengths and limitations:

Border barrier (the 'Wall')	700+ miles of steel fence/wall built since 1990s; Trump administration added ~450 miles; Biden paused then restarted. Sensors, cameras, motion detectors alongside physical barrier.	✓ Deters crossings in fenced areas ✗ Extremely expensive ($25m/mile) ✗ Migrants redirect to more dangerous remote desert crossings ✗ Addresses symptom not cause
Border Patrol & Technology	US CBP employs 19,000+ agents. Drone surveillance, ground sensors, helicopter patrols. 'Operation Streamline' (2005): criminal prosecution not just deportation.	✓ Reduces illegal crossings where deployed ✓ Intercepts drugs and trafficking ✗ Cannot cover entire 3,145 km border effectively ✗ Costly; doesn't address root causes
Asylum system & Legal Pathways	Migrants can present at official ports of entry to claim asylum. H-2A visa: temporary agricultural workers. Diversity Visa Lottery. DACA: protection for childhood arrivals.	✓ Provides safe, legal route ✓ DACA protected ~700,000 'Dreamers' ✗ Massive backlogs — 3 million cases pending ✗ Average wait: 4+ years for asylum decision
'Remain in Mexico' Policy (MPP)	Migrant Protection Protocols (2019-2022): asylum seekers must wait in Mexico while US case processed. Reversed by Biden 2021, reinstated by courts, fully ended 2022.	✓ Reduced overcrowding in US facilities ✗ Exposed migrants to violence in dangerous Mexican border cities ✗ Legally contested; humanitarian criticism
International Cooperation	US funds development programs in the 'Northern Triangle' (Honduras, Guatemala, El Salvador) to address root causes — $4 billion committed 2021-2024. Cooperation with Mexico on deportations.	✓ Addresses root causes — the only long-term solution ✗ Slow to show results ✗ Corruption limits effectiveness of aid ✗ $4bn small relative to scale of problem

Deportation & Removal	ICE (Immigration and Customs Enforcement) deports undocumented migrants. ~240,000 deported in FY2022. 'Sanctuary cities' refuse to cooperate with ICE — political conflict.	✓ Enforces immigration law ✗ Separates families (including US-born children) ✗ Deported individuals often return — 40% recidivism ✗ Humanitarian cost widely criticised

KEYWORDS & SELF-ASSESSMENT CHECKLIST

Migration		Internal migration	
International migration		Voluntary migration	
Forced migration		Economic migrant	
Refugee		Asylum seeker	
Push factor		Pull factor	
Intervening obstacle		Lee's Model	
Remittances		Brain drain	
Chain migration		Undocumented migrant	
Coyote (people smuggler)		Northern Triangle	
CBP (US Border Patrol)		DACA	

Exam Readiness Checklist

- ■ I can define migration and explain the difference between internal/international and voluntary/forced migration
- ■ I can explain push and pull factors with specific examples from Mexico and Central America
- ■ I can describe Lee's Model and explain each of the four components with examples
- ■ I can describe the main migration routes from Central America through Mexico to the USA
- ■ I can explain at least FOUR specific push factors driving Central Americans to migrate
- ■ I can name specific countries and give specific statistics (e.g. Honduras homicide rate; Mexico remittances)
- ■ I can evaluate the impacts on source countries (both positive AND negative with data)
- ■ I can evaluate the impacts on the destination country (both positive AND negative with data)
- ■ I can describe and evaluate at least THREE strategies used to manage migration at the US-Mexico border
- ■ I can write a PEEL paragraph structure for a 7-mark extended answer with a balanced conclusion

EXAM PRACTICE — PAPER 1 QUESTIONS

Instructions: Answer all questions using full sentences. Use named examples and data wherever possible. The mark scheme follows each question.

Q1 Define the term 'voluntary migration'. [1 mark] **[1 marks]**

✓ **Mark Scheme:** Movement by choice [1] — usually in search of better economic opportunities or quality of life [0 — no additional mark for expansion on 1-mark]. Do NOT accept 'moving voluntarily' — must show understanding.

Q2 State TWO push factors that cause people to migrate from Honduras to the USA. [2 marks] **[2 marks]**

✓ **Mark Scheme:** One mark each for any two of: gang violence / MS-13 and Barrio 18 [1]; extreme poverty / low wages [1]; unemployment especially among young people [1]; political instability / corruption [1]; climate-related crop failure / natural disasters [1]. Max 2 marks.

Q3 Explain how Lee's Model helps explain why people migrate from Central America to the USA. [3 marks] **[3 marks]**

✓ **Mark Scheme:** Lee's model identifies four factors [0 — no mark for just naming]: ORIGIN factors — gang violence, poverty (push people out) [1]; DESTINATION factors — higher wages, safety, family networks (pull people in) [1]; INTERVENING OBSTACLES — cost of journey/coyote ($3,000-10,000), US Border Patrol, 3,145 km border [1]; Personal characteristics — young working-age males most likely to migrate [1]. Max 3.

Q4 Explain TWO impacts of migration from Central America and Mexico on the USA. [4 marks] **[4 marks]**

✓ **Mark Scheme:** Two impacts, each worth 2 marks (1+1 or impact+explanation). Positive: migrants fill agricultural/construction labour shortages [1] — without them California's agriculture would face collapse [1]; contribute ~$2 trillion to US GDP [1]; demographic support for ageing population [1]. Negative: political tensions over border security [1] — immigration most divisive US political issue [1]; fiscal pressure on healthcare and schools in border states [1]; wage competition for low-skill native workers [1]. Accept positive OR negative. Max 4.

EXAM PRACTICE — 7-MARK EXTENDED RESPONSE

Q5 For a named migration you have studied, explain the causes of the migration. [7 marks] **[7 marks]**

PEEL PARAGRAPH FRAMEWORK — 7-MARK ANSWER

P **POINT — name the case study and make a clear statement**
Example: 'The migration of people from Central America and Mexico to the USA is caused by powerful push factors in source countries combined with strong pull factors in the USA.'

E **EVIDENCE — specific data and place names**
Example: 'Honduras has a homicide rate of 36/100,000 — one of the world's highest — caused by MS-13 gang violence, while the USA offers wages 5-10x higher than Central America.'

E **EXPLAIN — develop the point with geographic understanding**
Example: 'This extreme violence acts as a powerful push factor, forcing families to undertake the dangerous 3,000km journey through Mexico at a cost of $3,000-10,000 to reach safety.'

L **LINK — connect back to the question and evaluate**
Example: 'Overall, gang violence is the strongest push factor — Honduras (36/100,000 homicides) and El Salvador leave families no choice but to move. Economic factors combine with security to make migration almost inevitable for many Central Americans.'

✓ **Mark Scheme:** Level 3 (6-7 marks): Named case study (Central America/Mexico to USA) throughout; at least THREE specific push AND pull factors with data; named places; evaluative conclusion ('overall, the strongest cause is...'); factors explained not just listed. Level 2 (4-5 marks): Named case study; some specific data; push and pull factors identified but limited development or evaluation. Level 1 (1-3 marks): Generic or vague; push/pull factors named without explanation; no data. KEY DATA: Honduras homicide rate 36/100,000; youth unemployment 20-30% CA; US wages 5-10x higher than CA; coyote cost $3,000-10,000; family networks (37m Mexican-origin in USA); Hurricanes Eta/Iota 2020 destroyed livelihoods.

ALTERNATIVE 7-MARK QUESTIONS (EXAM PRACTICE)

Q5b For a named migration you have studied, describe the strategies used to manage migration and assess how successful they have been. **[7 marks]**

✓ **Mark Scheme:** Named: USA management of Central American/Mexican migration. Strategy 1 with evaluation: Border wall/fence (~700 miles built; $25m/mile; deters in built areas BUT migrants redirect to more dangerous desert routes — addresses symptom not cause). Strategy 2: Asylum system and legal pathways (DACA protects 700,000; BUT 3 million case backlog; 4+ year wait). Strategy 3: International development funding ($4bn for Northern Triangle) — only long-term solution BUT slow, results unclear, corruption limits effectiveness. Evaluative conclusion required for Level 3.

REVISION SUMMARY CARD — THEME 1.2 MIGRATION

DEFINITIONS & TYPES	CASE STUDY: CAUSES	IMPACTS	MANAGEMENT
Migration = movement of people Internal = within country International = across borders Voluntary = by choice (economic) Forced = no choice (conflict/persecution) Refugee = flees persecution Asylum seeker = applying for refugee status LEE'S MODEL: 1. Origin (push) factors 2. Destination (pull) factors 3. Intervening obstacles 4. Personal characteristics	PUSH (Central America/Mexico): • Gang violence: Honduras 36/100,000 homicides • Poverty: Honduras GDP/capita $2,900 • Unemployment 20-30% (youth) • Climate disasters (Hurricanes Eta/Iota 2020) • Political instability/corruption PULL (USA): • Wages 5-10x higher than CA • Safety and rule of law • Family networks (37m Mexican-origin in USA) • Education/healthcare ROUTE: Guatemala → Mexico → Border • 3,145 km border / 700+ miles fenced • Coyote cost: $3,000-$10,000 • 600+ desert deaths/year	SOURCE (Mexico/CA): Positive: • Remittances: Mexico $63bn/yr • El Salvador: 24% of GDP • Honduras: 27% of GDP • Reduces unemployment • Skills return with migrants Negative: • Brain drain (doctors, engineers) • Gender imbalance (male emigration) • Family breakdown • Dependency on remittances DESTINATION (USA): Positive: • Fills labour shortages in agriculture • Contributes ~$2 trillion to GDP • Demographic support for ageing population Negative: • Political polarisation • Pressure on border services • ~$68bn fiscal cost (est.)	1. Border barrier (wall/fence): ✓ Deters in built areas ✗ $25m/mile; redirects to desert 2. Border Patrol (CBP 19,000 agents): ✓ 2.47m encounters FY2023 ✗ Cannot cover entire border 3. Asylum / Legal pathways: ✓ DACA: 700,000 protected ✗ 3m case backlog; 4yr wait 4. Development aid (Northern Triangle): ✓ Only long-term solution ✗ Slow; $4bn insufficient 5. Deportation/removal: ✓ 240,000/yr removed ✗ 40% recidivism; family separation KEY FIGURES: 11m undocumented in USA 2.47m CBP encounters FY2023 3,145 km US-Mexico border

Resources: Cambridge IGCSE Geography 0460 Syllabus · UNHCR Global Trends Report · US CBP Border Statistics · World Bank Migration & Remittances Data · Pew Research Center · SAIS Geography Department